

Crispy Lemon Pepper Chicken Sandwich

Author: Aneta Total Time: 35 minutes Yield: 8 sandwiches 2x

This Crispy Lemon Pepper Chicken Sandwich is packed with juicy, golden-fried chicken, zesty lemon flavor, and a creamy tangy sauce—perfect for an easy, crowd-pleasing meal.



INGREDIENTS

- 4 boneless, skinless chicken breasts
- 2 cup buttermilk
- 2 cup all-purpose flour
- 2 tsp salt
- 2 tsp black pepper
- 2 tsp garlic powder
- 2 tsp onion powder
- 2 tsp paprika
- 1/2 tsp cayenne pepper
- 2 large egg
- 2 tbsp water
- 2 cup breadcrumbs
- Vegetable oil for frying
- 8 hamburger buns
- 1/2 cup mayonnaise
- 2 tbsp Dijon mustard
- 2 tbsp lemon juice
- 2 tsp lemon zest
- Shredded lettuce
- Sliced tomato
- Chopped fresh parsley



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INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Prep the chicken

Place the chicken breasts on a cutting board and carefully slice them horizontally to create thinner pieces. This not only speeds up cooking but also gives you more surface area for that irresistible crispy coating.

Step 3: Season and set up your dredging station

In a shallow bowl, combine the flour with salt, black pepper, garlic powder, onion powder, paprika, and a pinch of cayenne. In another bowl, whisk the egg and water until smooth. Place breadcrumbs in a third bowl.

Step 4: Coat the chicken

Remove the chicken from the buttermilk, letting any excess drip off. Dip each piece first in the flour mixture, making sure to cover both sides. Then dunk it in the egg wash, letting the excess drip off, and finally press it firmly into the breadcrumbs. Don't be afraid to really press the crumbs on—they're what give that gorgeous crunch.

Step 5: Heat the oil

Pour vegetable oil into a large skillet, enough to cover the bottom about 1/4 inch deep. Heat over medium-high until it's shimmering. To test if it's ready, drop in a tiny bit of flour—if it sizzles right away, you're good to go.

Step 6: Fry the chicken

Carefully lay the chicken pieces into the hot oil, leaving space between them so they crisp instead of steam. Cook 4–5 minutes per side until golden brown and the internal temp hits 165°F.

Step 7: Drain and rest

Transfer the chicken to a paper towel-lined plate to drain excess oil. Let it rest for a couple of minutes—it stays crispier this way.

Step 8: Toast the buns

While the chicken rests, lightly toast your hamburger buns in a dry skillet or toaster. Toasting gives a nice crunch and helps prevent soggy sandwiches.

Step 9: Make the sauce

In a small bowl, mix mayonnaise, Dijon mustard, lemon juice, and zest until creamy and smooth. Taste and adjust the lemon if you like it extra zippy.

Step 10: Assemble your masterpiece

Spread a generous layer of the sauce on each bun bottom. Place a piece of crispy chicken on top, then add shredded lettuce, tomato slices, and a sprinkle of parsley for color and freshness.

Step 11: Finish and serve

Cap it with the top bun and serve right away while everything is warm, crispy, and perfect. Trust me, these are best eaten immediately—no one likes cold soggy chicken!



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NOTES

Slice chicken thin for even cooking and extra crispy texture.

For a lighter version, bake at 400°F for 20–25 minutes, flipping halfway.

Best served fresh, but leftovers can be reheated in the oven.

Find it online: <https://chickenmagicrecipes.com/crispy-lemon-pepper-chicken-sandwich/>